harboured a strong feeling of resentment against the Soviet troops. Meanwhile, more Soviet troops began spreading all over Afghanistan, ostensibly to launch an attack on Muslim rebels as the revolutionary council headed by Babrak Karmal announced that Amin had been executed by the revolutionary tribunal for the crimes he had committed against the noble people of Afghanistan.

Days later, Babrak Karmal called Amin a CIA agent and a scheming spy of American imperialism; a traitor who did not have pity even on Taraki. He also promised to release all political prisoners and abolish all anti-democratic and anti-people regulations and support respect for the sacred principles of Islam.

The Afghan armed forces, demoralised and divided, remained practically inactive during the Soviet army's December 1979 operation. Though some units around Darulaman Palace resisted the Soviet troops, they had been quickly subdued. The following day, as Soviet T-55 tanks guarded the entry points to Kabul and fighter planes exercised surveillance, the Afghan army in and around Kabul was made to surrender and was later disarmed. Fuel and other essential supplies were withheld to prevent resistance. Indian intelligence operatives reported that reactionary circles in Pakistan, China, Saudi Arabia and Egypt, supported by the Americans, were training and arming mercenaries in military camps beyond the Afghanistan border. These mercenaries were called mujahideen and, accompanied by ISI agents, they aimed to enter Afghanistan.

On 27 January 1980, Kabul News Times reported that in training the mujahideen, Pakistan planned to kill three birds with one stone: first, show its irreconcilable enemy, India, that